

# The French asks about pawn chains

Opening Decisions

## THE IDEA

After 1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5, Black challenges White's center and develops a solid pawn structure. In the Advance line 3.e5, the center closes and pawn-chain attacks become central to planning. The blocked c8 bishop needs a future role.

## WORKED EXAMPLE

After 3...c5, Black attacks the d4 base supporting e5. White may support the chain with c3 while completing development. Both sides should prepare their breaks rather than shuffle pieces behind the pawns indefinitely.

## TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

**Why attack d4 instead of trying only to capture e5?**

## ANSWER AND REASONING

Weakening the chain's base can undermine the advanced pawn indirectly and open useful lines. Direct pressure on the head may also work, but the base is an important structural target.

## TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

**Study the pawn chain to understand the opening plan.**